

Quantum Fault Tolerance Meets Toom's Contours

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1 Toric Encoded Circuits

Definition 1.1 (Toric Encoded Circuit). Let C be a quantum circuit. We say that C is a *Toric encoded circuit* if the following holds:

1. There is a Toric code $\mathcal{C}$ such that the qubits of $\mathcal{C}$ can be partitioned into registers $R_1, \dots, R_k$, and, at any time, each of the registers is encoded either by the *nice encoding of $\mathcal{C}$* or by the *nice encoding of $\phi \circ H(\mathcal{C})$* ¹. At time $t = 0$, the registers are initialized to be either $|\bar{0}\rangle$ or encoded $|\mathbf{S}\rangle$.
2. The layers of C at even times are sweep-cycles, and the layers at odd times are realizations of one of the logical $\mathbf{H}$, $\mathbf{S}$, $\mathbf{CX}$, $\mathbf{X}$, or $\mathbf{Z}$ gates.

Definition 1.2 (The Boundary of Deviation ∂D_t). Let C be a Toric encoded circuit, with registers $R_1, \dots, R_l$ and let $\mathcal{E}$ be a set of faults. Consider the subjection $C[\mathcal{E}]$. For a time t , let $A_t, B_t \subset \{R_1, \dots, R_l\}$ be the registers that encoded, at time t in $C[\mathcal{E}]$, by $\mathcal{C}$ and $\phi \circ \mathbf{H}$ respectively. Denote by $\mathcal{D}_t$ the deviation in $C[\mathcal{E}]$ at time t . We define the *X-type*, and the *Z-type boundaries* of $\mathcal{D}_t$, denoted by ∂D_t^X and ∂D_t^Z , as follow:

$$\begin{aligned}\partial \mathcal{D}_t^X &:= \bigcup_{R_i \in A_t} \partial |R_{i,t}\rangle \cup \bigcup_{R_i \in B_t} \partial (\phi \circ \mathbf{H}) |R_{i,t}\rangle \\ \partial \mathcal{D}_t^Z &:= \bigcup_{R_i \in B_t} \partial |R_{i,t}\rangle \cup \bigcup_{R_i \in A_t} \partial (\phi \circ \mathbf{H}) |R_{i,t}\rangle\end{aligned}$$

Definition 1.3 (Base graph G_o). Let C be a quantum circuit, at depth d , with registers $R_1, \dots, R_k$, all of which are encoded by Toric codes with the same parameters (i.e., dimension, length, etc.). Let's denote by $\mathcal{G}_1, \dots, \mathcal{G}_k$ the Toric complexes that induce the codes. We define the base graph of C , denoted by $G_o = (V_o, E_o)$ as follows:

¹Notice that although the code space is invariant to the application of $\phi \circ \mathbf{H}$, the positive direction of the underlying Toric complex is flipped.

1. The vertices V_o are tuples, where the first coordinates correspond to a vertex in the union over the vertices in $\mathcal{G}_1, \dots, \mathcal{G}_k$, and the second coordinate is associated with a time. Namely:

$$V_o := \bigcup_i V(\mathcal{G}_i) \times [d]$$

2. The edges E_o are derived from the original edges in $\mathcal{G}_1, \dots, \mathcal{G}_k$, with the addition that any two vertices in preceding times t and $t+1$ that support qubits (faces) such that C acts non-trivially on those qubits at time t are also connected by an edge. Namely:

$$E_o := \{ \{(v, t), (u, t')\} : \text{if} \\ \text{either there exists } i \text{ such } \{v, u\} \in \mathcal{G}_i \text{ and } t' = t, t+1 \\ \text{or there exists } u_i = (g_i, l_i) \in C \text{ such } v, u \in l_{i,2} \text{ and } t = l_{i,1}, t' = l_{i,1} + 1 \}$$

[COMMENT] Here we should add that a vertex v belongs to location l if there is a qubit f that v belongs to its associated face.

Definition 1.4 (Tooms Contour Graph of $C(\mathcal{E})$). For a quantum circuit C and set of faults $\mathcal{E}$, let us denote the base graph of $C[\mathcal{E}]$ by G_o . For each time t , denote the deviation induced by $\mathcal{E}$ at time t by $\mathcal{D}_t$. We define the *Tooms contour graph* $\mathcal{H} = (V_{\mathcal{H}}, E_{\mathcal{H}})$ as follows:

1. The vertices $V_{\mathcal{H}}$ are partitioned into two types, X -type vertices $V_{\mathcal{H},X}$ and Z -type vertices $V_{\mathcal{H},Z}$. Each of the X/Z -type corresponds to the vertices supporting the X/Z -boundary of $\mathcal{D}$. Namely:

$$V_{\mathcal{H},X} := \{v_t : v_t = (v, t) \in V_o \text{ and there exists a face } f \in \partial \mathcal{D}_t^X \text{ such } v \in f\} \\ V_{\mathcal{H},Z} := \{v_t : v_t = (v, t) \in V_o \text{ and there exists a face } f \in \partial \mathcal{D}_t^Z \text{ such } v \in f\}$$

Similarly, the Z -type vertices $V_{\mathcal{H},Z}$ are the vertices $(v, t) \in V_o$, that satisfy that v belongs to a face associated with a check, which, at time t , belongs to the $(\partial \mathcal{D}_t)|_Z$.

2. The edges $E_{\mathcal{H}}$ is partitioned into two types $A_{\mathcal{H}}$ and $F_{\mathcal{H}}$, where for any logical gate g which applied in time t in $C[\mathcal{E}]$ we add edge to $A_{\mathcal{H}}$ as follow:

- (a) If g is a logical **CX** then for any physical **CX** in its realization, between faces f_1 into f_2 at time t we add:

$$\{ \{(u, t), (v, t+1)\} : u \in f_1, v \in f_1 \cup f_2 \text{ and } v, u \in V_{\mathcal{H},X} \} \\ \{ \{(u, t), (v, t+1)\} : u \in f_2, v \in f_1 \cup f_2 \text{ and } v, u \in V_{\mathcal{H},Z} \}$$

- (b) If g is logical $\phi \circ \mathbf{H}$, then for any physical $\mathbf{H}$, in its realization, that acts on face f , we add:

$$\{ \{(u, t), (v, t+1)\} : u \in f, v \in \phi(f) \text{ and } v \in V_{\mathcal{H},Z}, u \in V_{\mathcal{H},X} \} \\ \{ \{(u, t), (v, t+1)\} : u \in f, v \in \phi(f) \text{ and } v \in V_{\mathcal{H},X}, u \in V_{\mathcal{H},Z} \}$$

- (c) If g is one of logical X, Z, I or a sweep-cycle, then for any face f , in the register on which acts g , we add:

$$\begin{aligned} & \{ \{ (u, t), (v, t+1) \} : u, v \in f \text{ and } u, v \in V_{\mathcal{H}, X} \} \\ & \{ \{ (u, t), (v, t+1) \} : u, v \in f \text{ and } u, v \in V_{\mathcal{H}, Z} \} \end{aligned}$$

In addition for any fault g of $\mathcal{E}$, that is applied at time t , and any faces $f_1 \notin \text{Sup}_X(g)$ and $f_2 \notin \text{Sup}_Z(g)$, we add the edges:

$$\begin{aligned} & \{ \{ (u, t), (v, t+1) \} : u, v \in f_1 \text{ and } u, v \in V_{\mathcal{H}, X} \} \\ & \{ \{ (u, t), (v, t+1) \} : u, v \in f_2 \text{ and } u, v \in V_{\mathcal{H}, Z} \} \end{aligned}$$

To construct $F_{\mathcal{H}}$, we connect any pair of vertices $(v, t), (u, t)$ if there exists a vertex $(w, t+1)$ such both of them are connected to it through $A_{\mathcal{H}}$. Namely:

$$F_{\mathcal{H}} = \{ e = \{u, v\} \in E_o : \text{exists } w \in V_{\mathcal{H}} \text{ such } \{v, w\}, \{u, w\} \in A_{\mathcal{H}} \}$$

We call $A_{\mathcal{H}}$ and $F_{\mathcal{H}}$ the *arrows* and *forks* edges respectively. By definition of the construction, $G_{\mathcal{H}}$ is a time-graph.